

Session 7: Branding vs. Response Marketing

Key Points...

1. Two marketing philosophies:
 - There are two basic approaches to Marketing: Branding, and Response Marketing.
 - Branding is about getting people to "remember your name."
 - Response is about getting people to take ACTION and BUY.
2. Direct vs. Indirect Marketing:
 - The reason it's called "Direct Response Marketing" is because it's based on two key ideas that are very powerful together.
 - The first is marketing DIRECTLY to prospective customers & the second is asking for a RESPONSE.
 - Branding is "indirect" - in that its intention isn't to generate action NOW.
3. Conversion, not continuation.
 - In professional sales, a "continuation" is when you set-up a follow-up, but don't actually make a sale.
 - In Marketing (and sales), a "conversion" is when your Prospective Customer takes action - ideally buying what you're offering.
 - Aim for conversion, not continuation.
4. Branding is very, very appealing to "marketing chickens."
 - Most people default to branding or "getting their name out" - because it's the easy road.
 - You never have to face direct rejection if you never ask for a sale... which makes branding a very appealing route for most business owners.
 - You can always blame someone else when you don't take personal responsibility for sales.
5. Response Marketing has its root in direct, face-to-face selling.
 - The best way to think about a good Direct Response Marketing piece is to think of it like a real salesperson - only multiplied & automated.
 - The techniques of Direct Response have been tried, tested and refined over 100+ years.
 - It's now considered a "science" by the pros.
6. In person sales is the greatest "paid research" you can do.
 - Most people are afraid of selling their products and services "face-to-face."
 - In fact, it's the best possible research you can do for your business.
 - You'll never learn more specific, powerful things you can use in your marketing than when you SELL.
7. Do what big, successful companies DID - not what they do now.
 - Don't imitate the big companies - or assume that what they do will work for you
 - If you want to imitate them, go back to when they began and do what they DID...
 - ... and now what they're doing NOW!
8. And what they did when they started was usually SALES.
 - Sales has gotten a "bad name" over the past several decades.

- Professional Selling looks nothing like the manipulative hustling that we associate with the "used car salesman."
 - Professional Selling is about discovering and developing needs, then matching needs to solutions.
 - Professional Salespeople see the sales conversation as research into the prospective customer's needs.
9. Your first marketing should be in the spirit of direct sales.
- Don't aspire to have people "know your name" or "be famous."
 - Instead, aspire to have people who have a need come to you to buy what you're selling.
 - Instead of trying to become a "famous brand" - work to sell your product to one person at a time... then replicate this Direct Response system to grow.